

the epitome of political stability in the world's most dangerous nation, mired in a cesspool of tribulations coupled with unfathomable economic clutter.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

For the Record

I am extremely distressed to read the news article ("Family Feud", March 9, 2009). I have been in public life for the last 20 years, having held the office of the deputy speaker of the Delhi Legislative Assembly from 1999 to 2003 and am now Minister of State for Environment, Forests, Tourism, Sports and Youth Affairs in the Haryana Government. Yet, for reasons best known, I have been referred to as the "socialite daughter-in-law". I take strong objection to the phrase. That apart, the article refers to an alleged dispute over the ownership of former chief minister Bansi Lal's "multi-crore property in Delhi". I wish to clarify that my late father-in-law does not own any property in Delhi and this description is factually incorrect and false.

KIRAN CHOUDHRY,
Minister of State for Forests,
Environment, Tourism, Sports
and Youth Affairs, Haryana

Our correspondent replies: The property referred to in the story now stands in the name of Kiran Choudhry's

daughter, but there was a dispute regarding this property after Bansi Lal's death which led to an intervention by the Delhi Police. There was no offence meant in the use of the term "socialite daughter-in-law".

Mind and Matter

The distinguished speakers at the India Today Conclave include state leaders, potentates, politicians, businessmen, industrialists, and even

offence as the best defence. But why do people get conciliatory when talking about terrorism?

DR DILIP JOSHI, Pune

War on Terror

Politicians are meant for exterminating entrenched corruption and are elected to cleanse the country from such wicked malaises ("A Mighty Heart", April 6). Till date, no politician has dared to ensure a terror-free society. Prime Minister Manmohan Singh



SHAIKESH RAVAL

“ The problem with the Sangh Parivar is not age but its time-frozen mindset. To modernise the thought process of 75 crore young Indians, Mohanrao Bhagwat is the right choice. ”

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, via www.indiatoday.in

actors and filmmakers, who mouth oft-repeated platitudes, generalities and sanctimonious pearls of wisdom ("Challenges of Change", March 23). This year's affair was no different. General Pervez Musharraf, true to his form, acted like a master prevaricator and an artful dodger of questions. This old pugnacious warhorse believes in

may be too mild, but he can deal with terrorism sternly as was reflected post-26/11 Mumbai attacks. He is more efficient and competent than BJP's prime minister in-waiting L.K. Advani whose reign as home minister was marked by the attack on the Parliament and the Kandahar episode. IPPILI SANTHOSH KUMAR, via www.indiatoday.in

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30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

MAY 16-31, 1979

Growing Differences

As Sanjay Gandhi and his aggressive supporters battled policemen and shopkeepers on Janpath, Delhi's trendy shopping avenue, on May Day, his political strategists were busy planning a tactical retreat on the party front. For all their bravado and Mrs Indira Gandhi's firmness on the Sanjay issue, the usually timorous party rank and file is becoming more and more rebellious. Faced with a sure defeat of Sanjay's supporters in the elections to the various offices of the party's powerful parliamentary wing, his faction had no option but to step down. Their defeat would not only have exposed their isolation but also mushroomed into a threat to Mrs Gandhi's tenuous hold on the organisation. The key contest involved Charanjit Chanaana, an economist, and Kalpnath Rai, a boisterous MP with pretensions of being the Jack Anderson of Indian Parliament.

Arul Louis



SANJAY
GANDHI